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To:

The Commonwealth Scholarship Commission
United Kingdom

RE: RECOMMENDATION FOR MR. JOSEPH GAKUMO MUNYUI – COMMONWEALTH MASTER'S SCHOLARSHIP IN CYBERSECURITY

Dear Members of the Commonwealth Scholarship Commission,

I am pleased to write this recommendation in support of **Mr. Joseph Gakumo Munyui's application for a Commonwealth Master's Scholarship to pursue postgraduate studies in Cybersecurity in the United Kingdom.**

I write in my capacity as **Director, ICT, State Department for Correctional Services**, where Joseph is currently serving as an **ICT Intern**. During his time with the Department, I have had the opportunity to appreciate his technical capabilities, commitment to public service, willingness to learn, and ability to contribute to the deployment and support of ICT systems within a demanding government environment.

The State Department for Correctional Services has a broad mandate encompassing correctional administration, safe custody, rehabilitation and reintegration of offenders, administration of justice and the provision of information required by courts and correctional institutions. These responsibilities increasingly depend on reliable, secure and integrated information systems.

Within this environment, Joseph has demonstrated a practical understanding of how ICT contributes to institutional operations and service delivery. His responsibilities have included **ICT systems deployment and support, installation and configuration of systems and equipment, troubleshooting of hardware and software, networking and connectivity support, user support, systems maintenance, and resolution of day-to-day technical challenges.**

Of particular relevance to his proposed Master's studies, Joseph has gained exposure to **government financial management systems, including IFMIS/PFM-related support**, as well as correctional-sector digital systems. He has also participated in activities relating to the **implementation and support of the Integrated Correctional Management Information System (ICMIS)**, an important component of the Department's ongoing transition towards more integrated and digitally enabled correctional operations.

His involvement has given him practical exposure to the challenges associated with implementing ICT systems in a government environment, including **system availability, user access, networking, troubleshooting, information handling, operational continuity, system reliability and coordination with different users and technical stakeholders**. These experiences have helped him

appreciate that effective digital transformation is not only about deploying technology, but also about ensuring that systems are secure, dependable and appropriately managed.

Joseph has also been involved in technical activities associated with the **operationalization and commissioning process of the Wanini Kireri Magereza Level 4 Hospital**. This exposure provided an opportunity to participate in ICT-related activities supporting the integration and operational readiness of a major public health facility within the correctional services environment.

Through these assignments, Joseph has demonstrated an ability to approach technical problems systematically. When confronted with ICT challenges, he seeks to understand the underlying problem, identify possible causes, test appropriate solutions and provide practical support to users. He is also willing to seek guidance when necessary and incorporates feedback into his work. I have found him to be **adaptable, dependable, receptive to learning and capable of working effectively with colleagues and other stakeholders**.

His experience in the Department is particularly relevant to the field of **Cybersecurity**. Working with government information systems has exposed him to the importance of protecting information, controlling access to systems, maintaining reliable networks, ensuring system availability and supporting the confidentiality and integrity of institutional data. The increasing digitization of correctional services further reinforces the need for professionals who understand both ICT operations and the security requirements associated with critical public-sector systems.

The Department is progressively pursuing digital transformation, including efforts to automate correctional processes, improve connectivity and strengthen integrated information management. This environment provides Joseph with valuable practical exposure to the opportunities and challenges of securing government digital systems.

I therefore consider Joseph's proposed Master's study in Cybersecurity to be a **logical progression of his academic background and practical professional experience**. His Bachelor's degree in Computer Science, together with his software engineering training and practical exposure to government ICT, systems support, networking and information systems, provides him with a strong foundation upon which advanced cybersecurity knowledge can be developed.

I am particularly confident that postgraduate training in Cybersecurity would enable Joseph to deepen his understanding of areas such as **information security, secure systems administration, network security, cybersecurity risk management, data protection, incident response, secure digital infrastructure and resilience of critical information systems**. These skills have direct relevance to the continued modernization of government services in Kenya.

Beyond his technical abilities, Joseph has demonstrated qualities that I consider important for advanced study and future professional leadership. He is **curious, disciplined, willing to learn, persistent in solving problems and able to communicate technical issues to users and colleagues**. His experience supporting systems and users has also required patience, responsibility and an understanding of the importance of maintaining continuity of public services.

Joseph is currently undertaking his internship with the State Department for Correctional Services, with his **current internship tenure scheduled to conclude at the end of 2026**. During this period, he has used the opportunity to build practical experience in government ICT while contributing to the Department's day-to-day technical requirements and broader digital initiatives. His current position has therefore given him a valuable understanding of the operational realities of public-sector technology, which I believe will significantly enhance his ability to relate advanced Cybersecurity training to practical development challenges in Kenya.

Upon completion of his Master's studies, the knowledge and skills gained would place Joseph in a stronger position to contribute to the **protection of government information systems, strengthening**

of cybersecurity practices, secure digital transformation, protection of sensitive data and development of resilient ICT infrastructure. His experience in correctional and other public-sector systems gives him a practical context within which to apply this knowledge and contribute to Kenya's continuing digital transformation.

I believe Joseph has the **academic foundation, practical ICT experience, professional attitude and commitment to continuous learning** required to benefit from postgraduate study in Cybersecurity. His current experience in a government institution also provides him with a practical understanding of the development challenges that advanced ICT and cybersecurity skills can help address.

I therefore **strongly recommend Mr. Joseph Gakumo Munyui for consideration for the Commonwealth Master's Scholarship in Cybersecurity.** I am confident that the opportunity to undertake postgraduate studies in the United Kingdom would further develop his technical and professional capacity and equip him to make a meaningful contribution to secure and resilient digital services in Kenya.

Please feel free to contact me should you require any further information concerning his professional conduct, technical capabilities or experience within the State Department for Correctional Services.

Yours faithfully,

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TO: THE COMMONWEALTH SCHOLARSHIP COMMISSION

RE: REFERENCE FOR JOSEPH GAKUMO MUNYUI – COMMONWEALTH MASTER'S SCHOLARSHIP

Dear Members of the Commonwealth Scholarship Commission,

I am pleased to provide this reference in support of **Mr. Joseph Gakumo Munyui's** application for the Commonwealth Master's Scholarship to pursue postgraduate studies in Cybersecurity in the United Kingdom.

I had the opportunity to mentor and work with Joseph during his time in the health information technology environment where we both worked for a USAID Funded Project – HealthIT under University of Nairobi Enterprises and Services, where I observed his professional development, technical ability, commitment to learning and approach to problem-solving. From my interactions with him, I found Joseph to be a highly motivated and intellectually curious young ICT professional who consistently demonstrated a willingness to learn, accept guidance and apply new knowledge in practical settings.

Joseph has developed a strong foundation in computer science and Information Technology. His academic background in Computer Science, complemented by his professional training in software engineering, demonstrates a clear commitment to continuous professional development. His technical interests and experience span software development, databases, Linux administration, networking, health information systems and enterprise ICT environments.

During the period I interacted with Joseph, I was particularly impressed by his ability to approach technical challenges systematically. He demonstrated good analytical and problem-solving skills and was willing to investigate issues beyond their immediate symptoms in order to understand their underlying causes. He also showed an ability to communicate technical matters to users and colleagues in a practical and understandable manner.

Joseph's professional experience has also given him exposure to environments where information security, system reliability, access control and data confidentiality are important considerations. His work supporting health information systems and later government ICT systems has exposed him to the operational realities of maintaining secure and reliable digital services. I believe this practical exposure provides an appropriate foundation for advanced study in cybersecurity.

In addition to his technical abilities, Joseph has demonstrated personal qualities that I consider important for postgraduate study and professional leadership. He is determined, receptive to feedback, adaptable and resilient. He is not afraid to ask questions when faced with unfamiliar technical challenges, and he makes a genuine effort to understand and apply what he learns. His willingness to develop himself and take on new responsibilities has been evident throughout his professional progression.

I also consider Joseph to have good leadership potential. His experience supporting users, facilitating training and working with different stakeholders has helped him develop interpersonal and communication skills alongside his technical capabilities. I believe that further postgraduate training will strengthen his ability to take on greater technical responsibility and contribute to the development of secure digital systems in Kenya.

I consider a Master's degree in Cybersecurity to be a logical progression for Joseph's career. Kenya's increasing dependence on digital government services, healthcare information systems, financial platforms and other technology-enabled services creates a growing need for professionals who can combine technical development with strong cybersecurity knowledge. Joseph's existing background in software development, ICT systems and user support provides a practical foundation upon which advanced cybersecurity expertise can be built.

I am particularly confident that Joseph will be able to apply the knowledge gained through postgraduate study beyond his own professional development. With his experience in both public-sector and health-related technology environments, he has the potential to contribute to strengthening cybersecurity awareness, secure system implementation, data protection and resilient digital infrastructure in Kenya.

Based on my experience with Joseph, I therefore highly recommend him for the Commonwealth Master's Scholarship. I believe he has the academic foundation, professional motivation, personal qualities and potential to benefit significantly from postgraduate study and to apply that knowledge constructively in Kenya.

I would be pleased to provide any further information regarding my experience with Joseph should this be required.

Yours faithfully,

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